

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

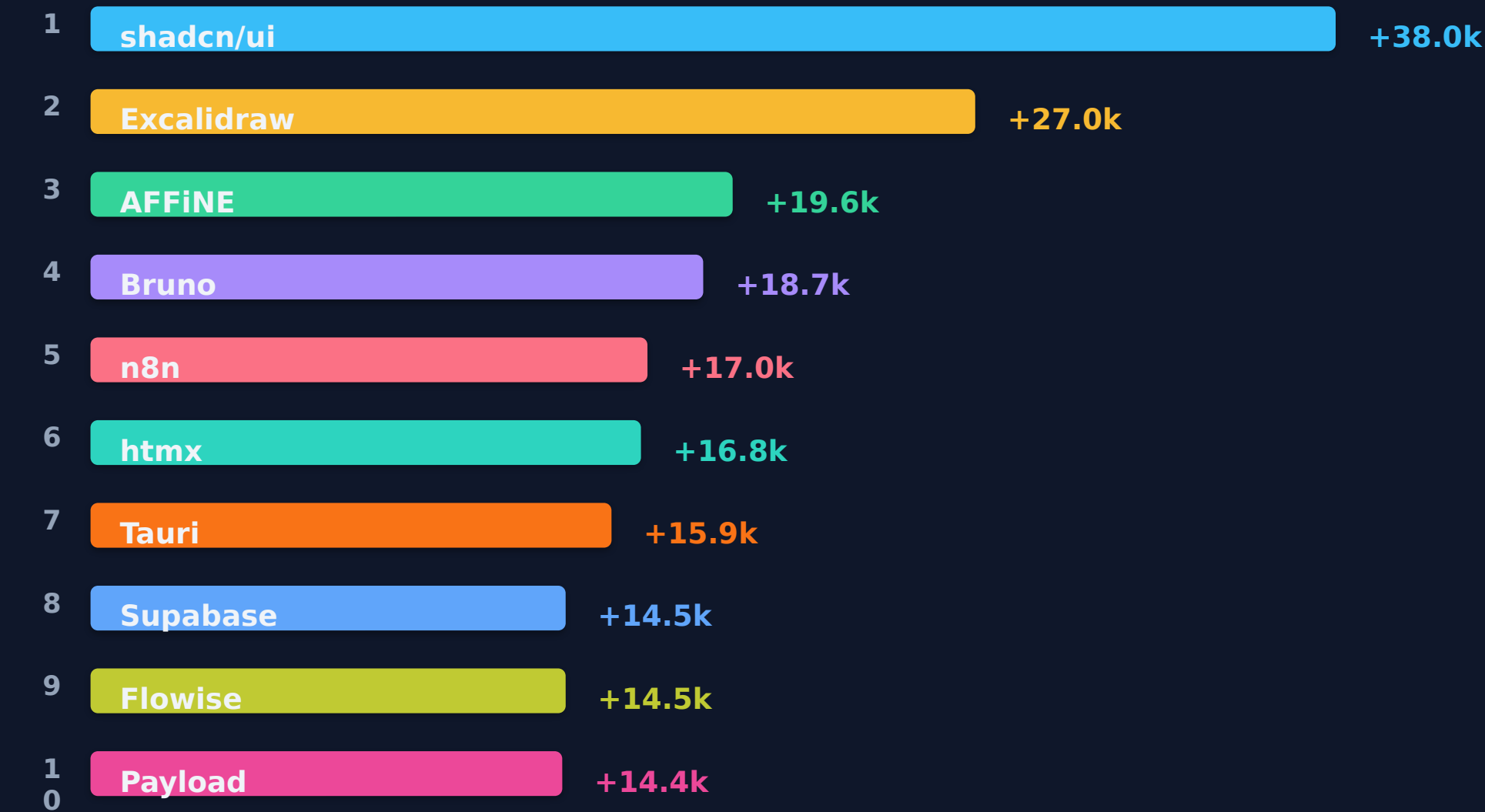
The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition • Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 from Best of JS curated list

Audience: Frontend Engineers & Engineering Managers

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE

Top 10 most-starred JavaScript projects on GitHub in 2024



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

Year-over-Year Growth

- 2023: +39.5k stars | 2024: +38.0k stars
- Total: 77.5k stars (created Jan 2023)

Key 2024 Additions

Charts (powered by Recharts)

Themes (CSS variable generation)

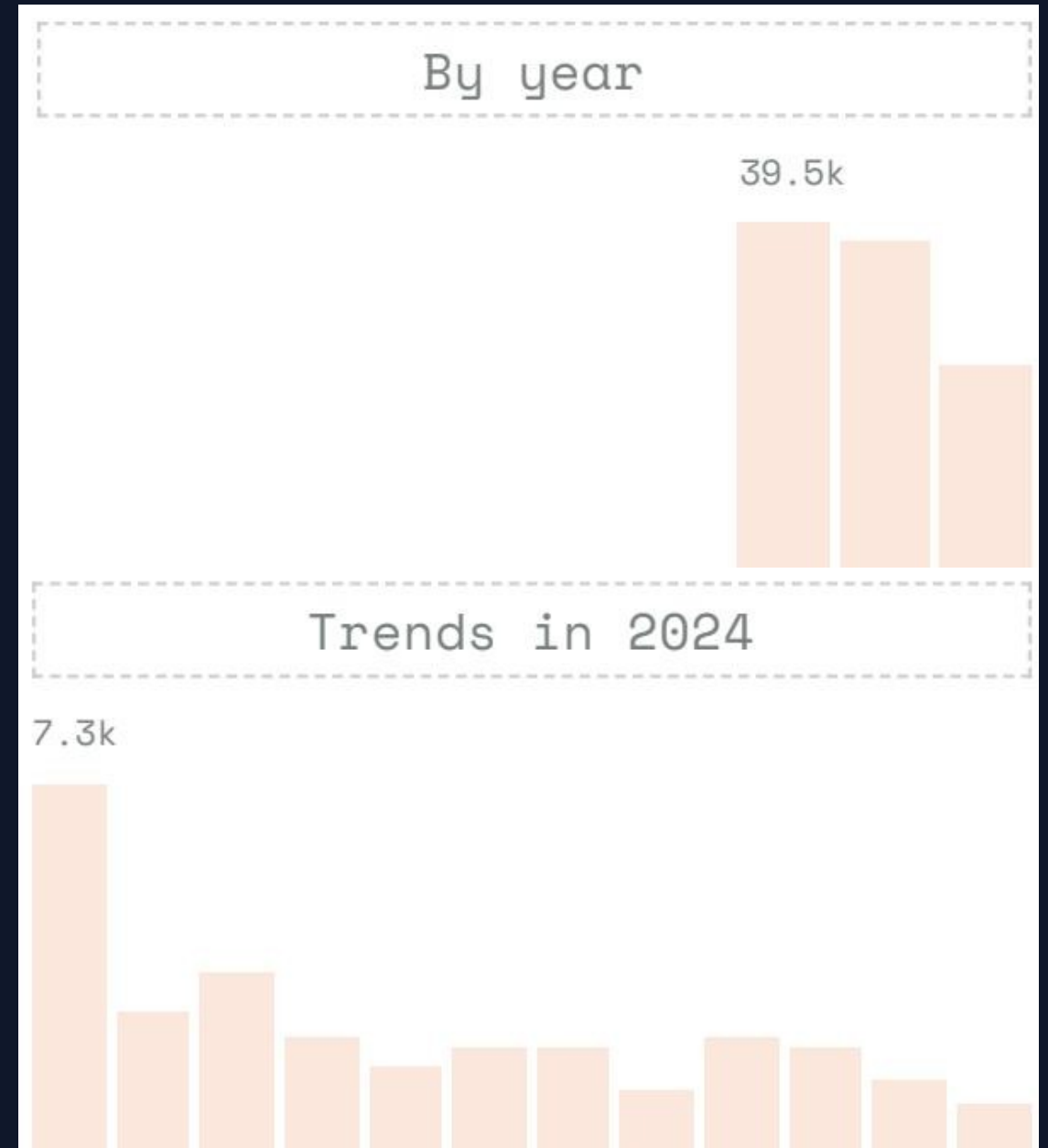
Blocks (layout collections)

Responsive sidebar component

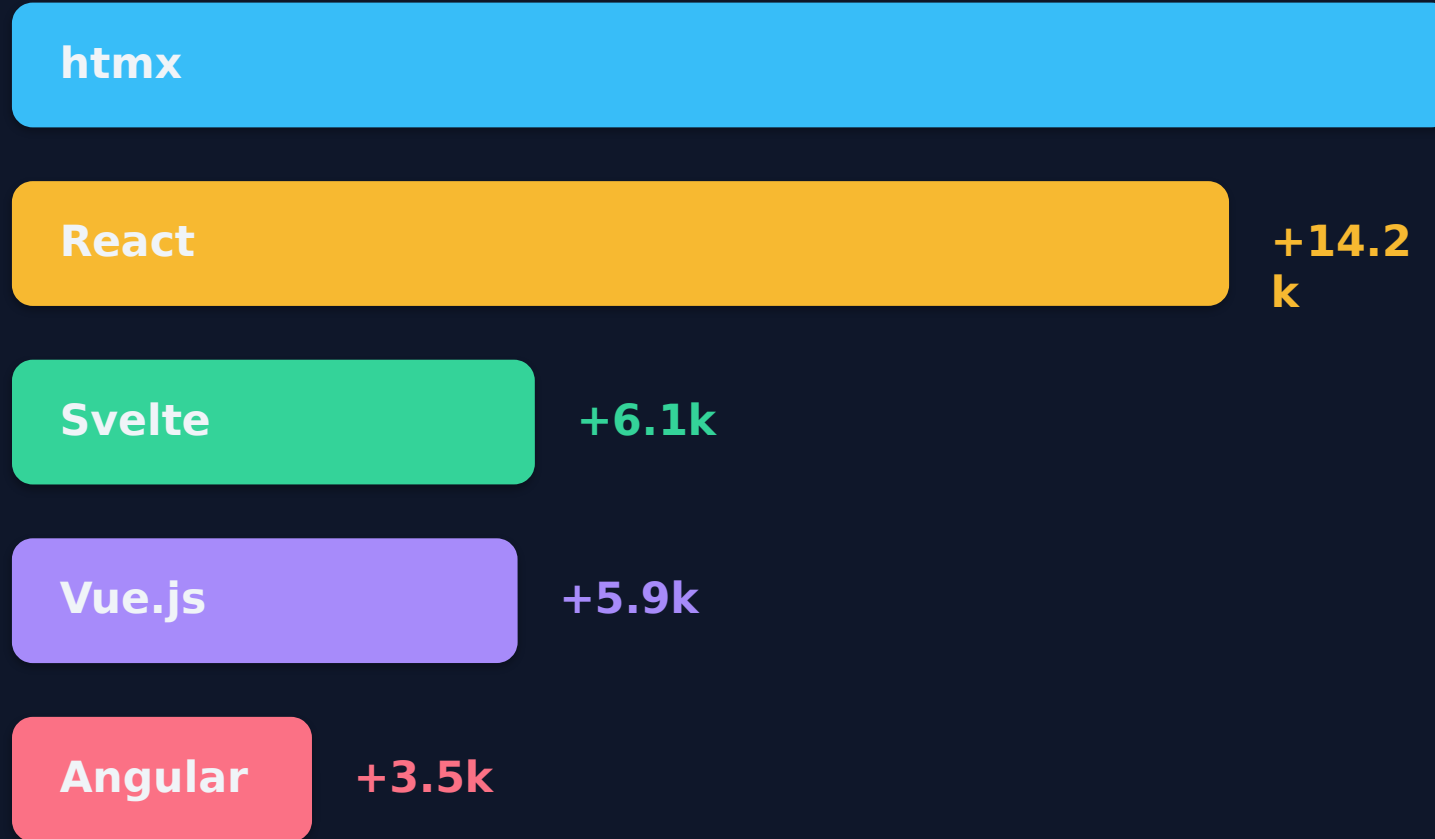
Upgraded CLI: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos

Registry ecosystem: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI

Vercel v0 AI-generated component integration



htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



Why htmx won

Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for AJAX & WebSockets—no JS required. Ideal for server-driven apps and progressive enhancement.

React 19 Highlights

- Server Components & Server Functions
- Custom Elements support
- New hooks & form actions
- React is evolving from a library into a specification for frameworks

Svelte 5 introduced 'runes'—explicit reactive state. Highest positive opinion in State of JS survey.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate



+27.0k



+14.4k



+13.2k



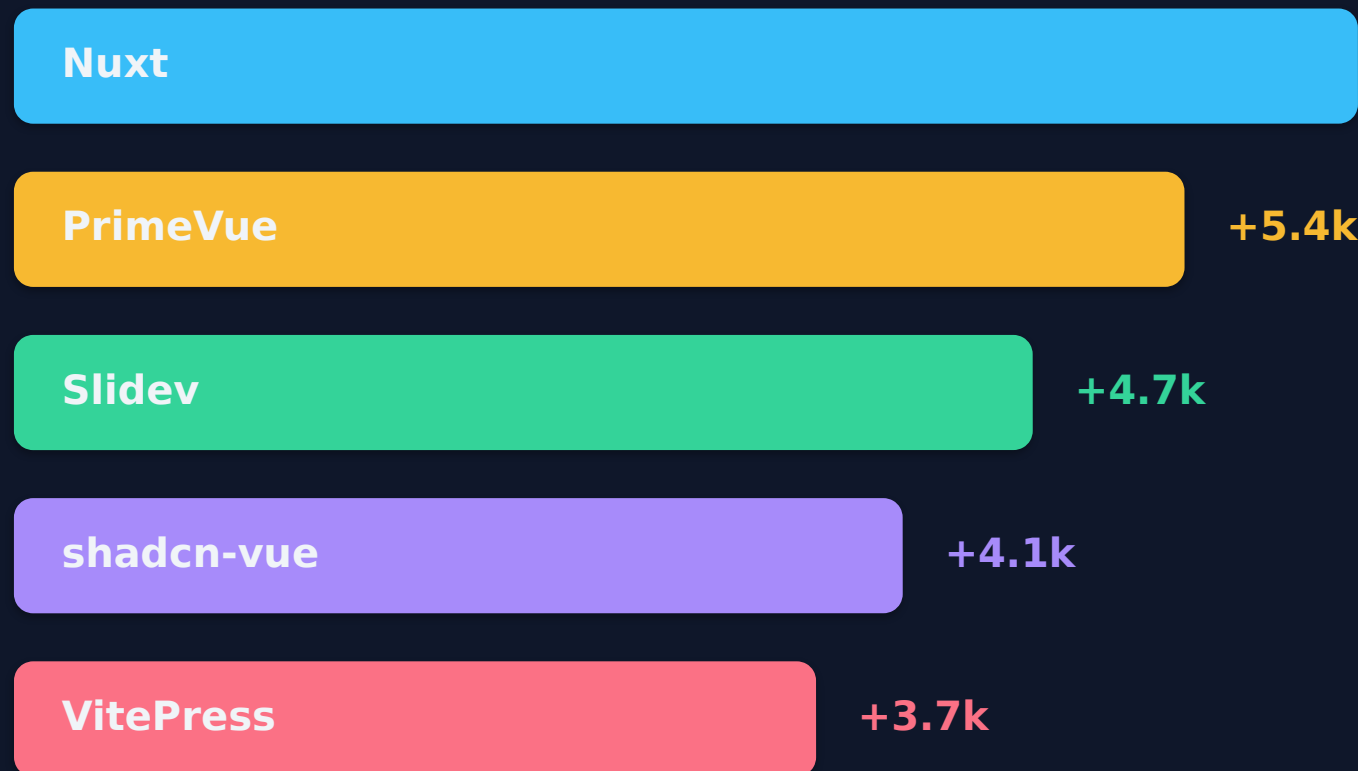
+12.1k

+38.0k **React's Evolution**

React 19 marks a shift from standalone library to framework specification. Next.js, Remix, and others now interpret React primitives differently—Server Components and Server Functions are becoming the new baseline.

Component ownership (shadcn/ui) and visual tools (Excalidraw, Magic UI) are the fastest-growing segments in the React orbit.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth



+6.2k Vue 3.5 & Ecosystem Signals

- Reactivity system reworked with lighter alien-signals approach (already in main branch)
- High-quality UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) signal growing ecosystem confidence
- Nuxt maintains active release cycle with regular performance improvements (per Daniel Roe)

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Projects

- n8n (+17.0k): fair-code workflow automation with native AI
- Flowise (+14.5k): drag & drop UI for custom LLM flows
- Supabase (+14.5k): open-source backend with AI integrations
- AFFiNE (+19.6k): knowledge base with AI capabilities

Desktop & Mobile

- Tauri (+15.9k): lighter desktop/mobile apps with web frontend
- Alternative to Electron with smaller bundle size

Browser Innovation

- PGLite: Postgres via WebAssembly in the browser
- WebVM: full virtual machine running entirely in the browser

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1 **Component ownership beats imports**

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model reached 77.5k total stars by letting developers own and customize code—proving staying power for a second year.

2 **HTML-first is serious**

htmx overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars added, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures.

3 **React is becoming a framework spec**

With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks now interpret React's primitives differently.

4 **AI integration is table stakes**

Four of the top 10 overall projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities or integrations.

5 **Vue's ecosystem maturity**

A wave of high-quality UI libraries and the Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing Vue ecosystem.

Heading into 2025: expect server-driven UI, AI-augmented workflows, and component ownership to remain the dominant forces shaping JavaScript adoption.